Waugh would stand there on the field and, when you walked out to the middle, greet you with a, ‘Hey, Hersch, we’ve been waiting for you.’ And I’d think, ‘Okay, here we go again.’ But when you got to 25 or 30 and it looked like you were going to be in for a bit, they tended to go fairly quiet.

Brian Lara

Brian Lara batted in a way that no one else ever has. He was able to get into positions at the crease that allowed him to hit and score off deliveries that would leave other batsmen floundering.

If you watch footage of Lara batting, you can see that he was always very crouched when he batted. And because he was standing quite low, once the ball got up higher than where he was, he could just pull it.

Whereas most Test batsmen might leave a ball of a certain length, Brian could score off it. As his feet were placed wider apart, it lowered his stance and allowed him to hit the ball really late. Just watch the way he used to cut on the off-side – he’d hit the ball very late, but with a lot of power. As hard as anybody I’ve ever seen.

Lara also had a very high back-lift, which meant that his bat speed through the hitting zone was immense. That high flourish allowed him to chuck in everything but the kitchen sink whenever a bowler offered any width. Most other batters would have sent this ball flying over slips or got caught at third man, but Brian always got on top of the ball, hit it fairly late and laced it past point, which takes incredible timing and coordination.

Lara didn’t deliver his best performances against South Africa – but remember, in his case it means that he didn’t score a triple or quadruple century against us! His highest score against the Proteas was ‘only’ 202 at the Wanderers in 2003 and, apart from that, he scored only three other Test centuries against us. I guess you could say our bowlers had his number … relatively speaking.

Still, the man was a total genius with the bat, scoring 11 953 Test runs (the second-highest total in history after Sachin Tendulkar) and 10 405 ODI runs. And, of course, he holds the highest Test-innings score, with 400 not out against England in 2004.

Ricky Ponting

Ponting represents the modern Aussie approach to cricket, specifically in batting. You hardly ever see the guy block the ball – even in Test cricket.